

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 4

Group 4 Vocabulary

1. Abstain

Meaning: To deliberately avoid or stop oneself from doing something.

Tip to remember: Think of “absent from action.” If you abstain, you stay away from an action.

Sentence: He decided to abstain from junk food during exam preparation.

2. Approbation

Meaning: Approval or praise.

Tip to remember: Approbation sounds like “approval.” Both mean acceptance or praise.

Sentence: Her research received the approbation of the committee.

3. Cherish

Meaning: To love, value, or protect something deeply.

Tip to remember: Think of something you keep close to your heart. You cherish it.

Sentence: He cherished the memories of his school days.

4. Corroborate

Meaning: To confirm or support a statement with evidence.

Tip to remember: Think of “co-robust.” Evidence makes an argument robust and strong.

Sentence: The witness corroborated the victim’s story.

5. Disparate

Meaning: Very different; not similar.

Tip to remember: Disparate sounds like “separate.” Things that are disparate are separate in nature.

Sentence: The team combined people from disparate backgrounds.

6. Emulate

Meaning: To imitate someone in order to equal or surpass them.

Tip to remember: Think of an emulator in computers. It copies another system. Emulate means to copy or imitate.

Sentence: Young scientists often emulate great researchers.

7. **Enervate**
Meaning: To weaken or drain energy.
Tip to remember: Enervate sounds like “energy evaporate.” Your energy disappears.
Sentence: The long lecture enervated the students.
8. **Ephemeral**
Meaning: Lasting for a very short time.
Tip to remember: Think of a flower that blooms in the morning and dies by evening. That beauty is ephemeral.
Sentence: Fame on social media can be ephemeral.
9. **Fervid**
Meaning: Very passionate, intense, or enthusiastic.
Tip to remember: Fervid sounds like “fever.” A fervid person has fever-like intensity.
Sentence: She gave a fervid speech about climate change.
10. **Garrulous**
Meaning: Excessively talkative, especially about unimportant things.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who keeps “garr-garr” talking nonstop.
Sentence: The garrulous passenger talked throughout the entire bus ride.
11. **Incendiary**
Meaning: Causing anger, conflict, or fire; inflammatory.
Tip to remember: Incendiary is related to fire. Incendiary words can start a social fire.
Sentence: His incendiary comments created tension in the meeting.
12. **Inimical**
Meaning: Harmful or hostile.
Tip to remember: Inimical sounds like “enemy.” Something inimical acts like an enemy.
Sentence: Pollution is inimical to public health.
13. **Intimate**
Meaning: To suggest or hint indirectly; also, close and personal.
Tip to remember: On the GRE, intimate often means “hint.” Think of giving a small, private hint.
Sentence: The report intimated that the company had hidden the truth.
14. **Invigorate**
Meaning: To give energy, strength, or enthusiasm.
Tip to remember: Think of “vigor,” which means energy. Invigorate means to put energy in.
Sentence: A short walk can invigorate your mind.
15. **Mitigate**
Meaning: To make something less severe, serious, or painful.

Tip to remember: Think of “mini-gate.” You make a big problem smaller, like making it mini.

Sentence: Trees help mitigate the effects of air pollution.

16. **Obsolete**

Meaning: No longer useful or no longer in use.

Tip to remember: Think of old technology like floppy disks. They are obsolete.

Sentence: Many old machines became obsolete after automation.

17. **Opaque**

Meaning: Not transparent; difficult to understand.

Tip to remember: An opaque glass cannot be seen through. An opaque explanation cannot be understood easily.

Sentence: The legal document was opaque to ordinary readers.

18. **Paradigmatic**

Meaning: Serving as a typical or perfect example of something.

Tip to remember: A paradigm is a model or example. Paradigmatic means model-like.

Sentence: Einstein is a paradigmatic example of scientific genius.

19. **Pedantic**

Meaning: Too concerned with small details or rules, especially in a boring way.

Tip to remember: Think of a teacher who corrects every tiny mistake unnecessarily. That is pedantic.

Sentence: His pedantic explanation made a simple topic confusing.

20. **Placid**

Meaning: Calm, peaceful, and undisturbed.

Tip to remember: Placid sounds like “placid lake.” A quiet lake is calm and still.

Sentence: The placid lake reflected the mountains clearly.

21. **Polemical**

Meaning: Related to strong argument or controversy.

Tip to remember: Think of people standing on opposite poles and arguing. Polemical writing attacks or debates strongly.

Sentence: The article was polemical and criticized the government sharply.

22. **Precipitate**

Meaning: To cause something to happen suddenly; also, done too quickly.

Tip to remember: In chemistry, a precipitate suddenly appears in a solution. In life, precipitate actions happen suddenly.

Sentence: The leader’s speech precipitated a public protest.

23. **Profundity**

Meaning: Great depth of thought, meaning, or feeling.

Tip to remember: Profundity comes from “profound,” meaning deep.

Sentence: The profundity of his ideas impressed the audience.

24. **Prophetic**

Meaning: Accurately predicting what will happen in the future.

Tip to remember: A prophet predicts the future. Prophetic means prediction-like.

Sentence: Her warning about climate change now seems prophetic.

25. **Prudent**

Meaning: Careful, wise, and sensible in making decisions.

Tip to remember: Think of a prudent person checking everything before investing money.

Sentence: It is prudent to save money for emergencies.

26. **Punctilious**

Meaning: Very careful about details, rules, and proper behavior.

Tip to remember: Punctilious sounds like “punctual.” Both suggest carefulness and discipline.

Sentence: The punctilious editor noticed every small mistake.

27. **Recondite**

Meaning: Difficult to understand; known by only a few people.

Tip to remember: Think of knowledge hidden in a remote corner. Recondite knowledge is hard to access.

Sentence: The book discusses recondite topics in philosophy.

28. **Scrupulous**

Meaning: Very honest and careful about doing what is right.

Tip to remember: Think of someone carefully checking every action to avoid doing wrong.

Sentence: A scrupulous researcher never changes data dishonestly.

29. **Tranquil**

Meaning: Peaceful, calm, and quiet.

Tip to remember: Think of a quiet morning beside a lake. That scene is tranquil.

Sentence: The village was tranquil after sunset.

30. **Vacillate**

Meaning: To keep changing one’s mind; to hesitate between choices.

Tip to remember: Think of a fan moving left and right. A person who vacillates moves between decisions.

Sentence: He vacillated between studying in Nepal and applying abroad.